

BEN YACKER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Construction Project Manager specializing in large-scale EV charging infrastructure deployment and public-private partnership (PPP) delivery across the northeastern U.S. Currently overseeing \$200M+ in active site construction as part of a \$1B+ capital program deploying 400kW DC fast-charging stations across 35+ locations on major state travel corridors in NY, NJ, PA, and DE. Deep expertise in medium-voltage utility interconnection, state clean energy mandate compliance, and government agency coordination. Columbia University-educated; proven track record delivering concurrent multi-site EV infrastructure programs on schedule and within budget.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Construction Project Manager | Applegreen

April 2025 – Present

Multinational energy and convenience retail operator · 550+ locations across USA, UK & Ireland

- Own end-to-end delivery of \$200M+ in active site construction value across 80+ service areas as part of a \$1B+ Blackstone-backed capital investment program, directly accountable to ownership for schedule, budget, quality, and safety outcomes across PPP contracts with 6 state highway authorities including NY State Thruway (27 areas), NJ Turnpike Authority (21 areas), PA Turnpike Commission (17 areas), and additional state systems
- Oversee deployment of 400kW DC fast-charging stations across 80+ service areas operated under state authority PPP contracts, including NY State Thruway (27 areas, \$450M redevelopment), NJ Turnpike/South Jersey Turnpike (21 areas), PA Turnpike (17 areas), and systems in CT, ME, IN, CO, MA, and DE
- Advance state clean energy mandates through each PPP contract, directly supporting 100% EV coverage commitments on NY and NJ state highway systems and contributing to carbon reduction goals aligned with the NY Climate Leadership and Community Protection Act and NJ Clean Energy Program targets
- Drive medium-voltage utility interconnection process for each site, personally coordinating load studies, 500kVA–2,000kVA pad-mount transformer sizing, switchgear configurations, and service entrance upgrades with licensed electrical engineers and utility authorities (ConEd, PSEG, PECO, Delmarva Power) from interconnection application through energization
- Coordinate standby power system integration at each site, working with electrical engineers on diesel generator sizing, UPS specifications, and automatic transfer switch (ATS) configurations to ensure continuous power availability for critical charging equipment during grid outages
- Oversee energization acceptance testing and commissioning for each installation, coordinating between EV charging equipment vendors, electrical contractors, and utility authorities to validate service entrance performance, charging station functionality, and grid stability prior to site turnover
- Partner with licensed MEP engineers on critical power system design reviews, validating single-line diagrams, load calculations, and utility coordination documents against program specifications before field execution
- Own end-to-end permitting outcomes across municipal, utility, electrical, and inspection domains in multiple state jurisdictions, maintaining zero permit-related schedule delays through proactive agency coordination and early application strategy
- Drive 30+ subcontractors to program deadlines across concurrent active sites; own RFP coordination, bid evaluation, and scope negotiation for all multi-state trade contracts, accountable for award decisions aligned with program budget and timeline
- Serve as sole owner's representative in all government agency, state authority, and PPP compliance interactions

Project Coordinator | FRAM+Slokker

2023 – 2025

Award-winning mixed-use developer · Brightwater is one of North America's landmark master-planned communities

- Served as primary execution lead for senior PM across all active phases of a ~\$3B USD master-planned waterfront development on a remediated former industrial site, with direct accountability for subcontractor performance, RFI resolution, budget tracking, and permitting outcomes
- Owned accountability for \$150M+ in phase-dedicated construction budgets across concurrent active phases; collaborated with development and finance teams on monthly budget reconciliation, tracking construction costs against the pro forma and providing cost analysis for ownership and investor reporting

- Prepared and delivered monthly construction progress reports to the owner and investment committee, providing schedule status, risk assessments, and recovery plan recommendations that informed project-level development decisions
- Drove subcontractor procurement across 25+ active trade contracts spanning structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, envelope, and finishing scopes; managed 25+ subcontractors simultaneously from mobilization through final turnover
- Took direct ownership of subcontractor safety compliance through weekly toolbox talks, safety plan reviews, and site audit protocols, maintaining zero lost-time incidents across all active phases
- Drove owner design review process across SD, DD, and CD phases, coordinating architect and MEP consultant responses to owner comments, tracking design changes against budget and constructability requirements, and ensuring procurement-ready documents on schedule
- Managed change order process on behalf of the owner, evaluating GC proposals for merit, negotiating scope and pricing, and tracking approved changes against phase budgets; identified constructability conflicts during design reviews that reduced post-construction change exposure
- Processed 400+ RFIs and submittals; led full permitting portfolio including municipal/zoning, building permits, environmental assessments, utility coordination, and occupancy inspections with zero delays across any phase
- Coordinated environmental compliance for development on a remediated former industrial waterfront site, overseeing stormwater controls, erosion and sediment measures, and regulatory reporting; oversaw delivery of 18+ acres of public park and open space integrated into the master plan

EDUCATION

Post-Graduate Certificate, Construction Project Management | *Columbia University*
Engineering Division

Graduate Certificate, Construction Management | *George Brown College*
Angelo DelZotto School of Construction Management

Undergraduate Degree, Building Technology | *George Brown College*

CERTIFICATIONS

OSHA 30-Hour Construction Safety Certification

TECHNICAL SKILLS & CORE COMPETENCIES

EV Infrastructure: 400kW DC fast-charging deployment, state clean energy compliance, NY CLCPA/NJ Clean Energy Program, multi-corridor EV coverage programs

Electrical Infrastructure: Medium-voltage interconnection, load studies, transformer sizing, ATS, UPS, generator specs, energization commissioning

Program Management: Multi-site PPP delivery, design-build coordination, government agency liaison, owner's representation, multi-state permitting

Construction Management: Multi-trade coordination, RFI/submittal management, budget & schedule control, subcontractor procurement, change order management

Software: Procore, MS Project, Primavera P6, Bluebeam, AutoCAD (reading), BIM/Revit (reading), MS Office Suite